@FLEXAPPEALFFL · 2026 SEASON · WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

THE FLEX APPEAL WEEKLY

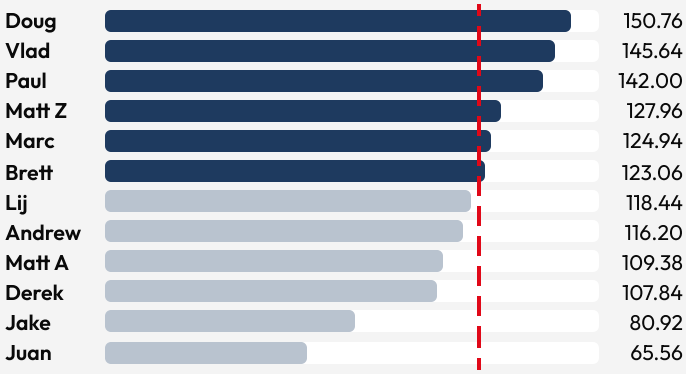
Week 5 in review · The trade frenzy · Week 6 preview

3	120.75	150.76	11	1
teams at 8-2	Week 5 median (2026 high)	Doug, week high	trades, Oct 10–15	veto + first-ever appeal

Five weeks are in the books, and with dual records (head-to-head plus the weekly median) that means ten results per team. Three teams sit at **8-2**: Brett, Doug and Marc, with Paul right behind at 7-3. At the other end, the commissioner is **0-10**, matching Marc's 2024 start for the worst in league history. It was also the busiest trading week the league has seen.

WEEK 5 IN REVIEW

EVERY SCORE VS THE MEDIAN



- - - median 120.75 · navy = beat the median (2-0 week), gray = missed it (0-2 week)

WINNER	PTS	LOSER	PTS	MARGIN
Vlad WHO's YOUR VLADDY	145.64	Jake Top Play	80.92	64.72
Marc Walker? Barely know her	124.94	Juan Red Cross	65.56	59.38
Doug 9 - 5	150.76	Lij Taylor Swift	118.44	32.32
Paul Rudy	142.00	Andrew Carried by RA	116.20	25.80
Matt Z Rolling With Mahomies	127.96	Derek my njigba	107.84	20.12
Brett Paper Kings	123.06	Matt A CTE	109.38	13.68

Every head-to-head winner also cleared the median, so the week split cleanly: six teams went 2-0 and six went 0-2. Brett cleared the line by 2.31; Lij missed it by exactly the same margin.

Doug posted the week's high, **150.76**, the third-best score of the season, led by Drake Maye's 39.46, the second-best individual start of 2026. **Vlad** handed Jake the week's biggest beating, 145.64 to 80.92, a 64.72-point margin that ranks third this season; Jahmyr Gibbs went for 35.20, his second 35-point game of the year. **Marc** finally broke Juan's spell: Juan had been 5-0 all-time against him, and Marc won 124.94-65.56. Juan's 65.56 was the second-lowest score of 2026.

The headline game delivered too. **Brett beat Matt A 123.06-109.38**, the closest game of the week, ending Matt A's six-result win streak and extending his own to six. Paul rode Jaylen Warren (33.80) and Josh Allen (31.50) to 142.00, and Matt Z bounced back behind Jayden Daniels' 32.26. Bucky Irving's 30.50 for Lij came in a loss, and Will Anderson's 20.00 for Marc was the week's top IDP score.

Hindsight was cruel. Derek's best possible lineup (120.14) would still have missed the median by 0.61, the second straight week his perfect lineup came up just short. Lij benched Rashod Bateman (8.7) for T.J. Hockenson (1.2), and Andrew sat Hunter Henry (11.9) behind Jaylen Waddle (3.8); his best lineup (124.30) would have cleared the median. Both 0-2 weeks could have been 1-1. Jake started the week with an empty WR slot.

STANDINGS AFTER WEEK 5

#	OWNER · TEAM	RECORD	H2H	VS MED	POINTS FOR	PD
1	**Brett** Paper Kings	**8-2**	4-1	4-1	665.04	+96.28
2	**Doug** 9 - 5	**8-2**	4-1	4-1	609.26	+75.56
3	**Marc** Walker? Barely know her	**8-2**	4-1	4-1	608.60	+164.16
4	**Paul** Rudy	**7-3**	4-1	3-2	619.86	+13.40
5	**Matt Z** Rolling With Mahomies	**6-4**	3-2	3-2	578.54	-29.88
6	**Matt A** CTE	**6-4**	3-2	3-2	574.14	+45.40
7	**Lij** Taylor Swift	**6-4**	3-2	3-2	566.06	+41.98
8	**Vlad** WHO's YOUR VLADDY	**5-5**	2-3	3-2	591.86	+10.94
9	**Derek** my njigba	**3-7**	2-3	1-4	524.74	-3.84
10	**Andrew** Carried by RA	**2-8**	1-4	1-4	486.18	-91.96
11	**Juan** Red Cross	**1-9**	0-5	1-4	439.98	-160.36
12	**Jake** Top Play	**0-10**	0-5	0-5	438.12	-161.68

8 wins · 6–7 · 3–5 · 0–2 · ties broken by points for, matching Sleeper

THE TRADE FRENZY

Between Oct 10 and Oct 15, eleven trades went through on Sleeper. The contenders bought, the bottom two sold, and one deal ended up in front of a jury. All picks are 2027 picks.

Oct 10
Juan gets
Love, Andrew's 10th
⇄
Andrew gets
Deebo Samuel, Justin Jefferson

Oct 10
Juan gets
Blake Corum, Rome Odunze
⇄
Brett gets
Terry McLaurin, Brian Robinson

Oct 13
Jake gets
Doug's 2027 1st
⇄
Doug gets
Tyreek Hill, DeVonta Smith, Chase Brown

Oct 13
Andrew gets
Vlad's 2027 5th
⇄
Matt Z gets
Jaylen Waddle

Oct 13
Juan gets
Matt Z's 1st, Marc's 3rd
⇄
Matt Z gets
Rashee Rice, Marvin Harrison Jr.

Oct 13
Jake gets
Lij's 2027 5th
⇄
Lij gets
DJ Moore

Oct 13
Jake gets
Andrews, Metcalf, Stroud, R. Wilson, Marc's 8th, Matt Z's 3rd
⇄
Marc gets
Stafford, Pollard, Marks, Gordon, Jake's 9th

Oct 15
Matt A gets
Tuten, Juan's 3rd
⇄
Juan gets
Matt A's 2nd

Oct 15
Matt Z gets
Rhamondre Stevenson
⇄
Andrew gets
Kaelon Black, Matt Z's 5th

Oct 15
Andrew gets
Makai Lemon, Matt Z's 11th
⇄
Matt Z gets
Kaelon Black, Andrew's 12th

Oct 15 — **VETOED**
Brett gets
Deebo Samuel, Justin Jefferson
⇄
Andrew gets
Terry McLaurin, Brett's 3rd

BUYERS VS SELLERS

◀ BUYING TO WIN NOW — BUILDING FOR 2027 ▶

Doug	Marc	Brett	Matt Z	Matt A	Lij	Paul	Vlad	Derek	Andrew	Juan	Jake
8-2	8-2	8-2	6-4	6-4	6-4	7-3	5-5	3-7	2-8	1-9	0-10
Big buyer	Big buyer	Buyer (veto)	Most active buyer	Buyer	Buyer	Quiet	Quiet	Quiet	Both ways	Seller	Seller

The top three all made moves. Doug spent his 2027 1st on Tyreek Hill, DeVonta Smith and Chase Brown in a push for a third title. Marc took Stafford, Pollard, Marks and Gordon off the commissioner's hands, and Brett added McLaurin and Brian Robinson. **Matt Z** was the most aggressive buyer of all: Rice, Harrison, Waddle and Stevenson arrived in three days, at the cost of his 1st and a 5th. Matt A paid a 2nd for Tuten and a 3rd, and Lij added DJ Moore for a 5th. Paul, Vlad and Derek had no completed trades.

The bottom two are building for 2027. Juan (1-9) turned Rice, Harrison, McLaurin, Deebo, Jefferson and Tuten into Love, Odunze, Corum, Matt Z's 1st, Matt A's 2nd and Marc's 3rd. Jake (0-10) sold his veterans and now holds two 2027 1sts (his own and Doug's), sitting at the 18-pick cap. **Andrew** (2-8) went both ways: he bought Jefferson and Deebo from Juan, moved Waddle to Matt Z, swapped pieces with Matt Z twice, then tried to send Jefferson and Deebo on to Brett.

THE VETO SAGA: BRETT / ANDREW

On Oct 15, a deal sending **Deebo Samuel and Justin Jefferson** from Andrew to Brett, for **Terry McLaurin and Brett's 2027 3rd**, processed on Sleeper. It was the only trade of the week to go to a league vote.

1 · Review	2 · Vote	3 · Appeal	4 · Counter	5 · Final
Commish reviews every trade within 24 hours (Bylaw 1.2, Good Faith)	Veto needs 6 of the 10 managers not in the deal. It passed	First-ever panel: Lij, Derek and Marc, deciding 2 of 3	Panel proposed Brett's 2nd + 4th for Jefferson	Brett declined. Veto stood; rosters restored

A veto requires the 10 uninvolved managers to agree, 6 or more, that a deal undermines the league's competitive integrity. That is separate from the commissioner's power to reverse a trade for collusion, tanking or sabotage, and no one alleged collusion here. The question in front of the league was value. Brett appealed, sending a trade to a panel for the first time in league history. Each side submitted its case, and the three neutral managers, **Lij, Derek and Marc**, could uphold the veto, reverse it, or propose a revised deal. They chose a revision: **Brett's 2nd and 4th for Jefferson**. Brett declined, so the veto stood and the commissioner restored Jefferson and Deebo to Andrew and McLaurin to Brett.

The precedent: a panel can now rewrite a trade instead of just killing it.

Reasonable people landed on both sides. One view is that a 2-8 team was simply selling to a contender, which is how deadlines work. The other is that sending Jefferson and Deebo to the league's points leader (665.04 PF) for that return went too far.

WEEK 6 PREVIEW

GAME OF THE WEEK

Matt Z	vs	Brett
6-4		8-2
Series: Matt Z 1-0		**Brett 11.5 – 4.4**

CHAMPS COLLIDE

Doug	vs	Vlad
8-2		5-5
Series: Vlad 3-2		**Doug 13.1 – 0**

Matt A	vs	Marc
6-4		8-2
Series: Matt A 1-0		**Not started**

JSN 19.4, SHAHEED 9.3

Paul	vs	Derek
7-3		3-7
Series: Paul 2-1		**Derek 33.90 – 12.10**

RUBBER MATCH

Lij	vs	Andrew
6-4		2-8
Series: Tied 1-1		**Andrew 8.0 – 0**

BOTTOM-TWO CLASH

Jake	vs	Juan
0-10		1-9
Series: Juan 3-0		**Not started**

Thursday night: the Broncos beat the Seahawks 17-14. Derek got the best of it, jumping to a **33.90-12.10** lead on Paul behind Jaxon Smith-Njigba (19.4) and Rashid Shaheed (9.3). Doug's RJ Harvey put up 13.1 while Vlad has yet to score, Brett's Ernest Jones scored 11.5 to Matt Z's 4.4, and Andrew leads Lij 8.0-0.

Matt Z vs Brett is the game of the week. Brett has won six straight results and leads the league in points (665.04) and touchdowns (39). Matt Z is second in touchdowns (34), has faced more points than anyone (608.42), and debuts a receiver room rebuilt around Rice, Harrison and Waddle. He won the only previous meeting.

Doug vs Vlad brings together the two-time champion (2023, 2024) and the defending champion; Doug adds Hill, Smith and Chase Brown, while Vlad dropped 145.64 last week and leads the series 3-2. **Matt A vs Marc** pits a Matt A team that just had its streak snapped against a Marc team that has won six straight results, holds the best point differential (+164.16), and now adds Stafford, Pollard, Marks and Gordon.

Paul vs Derek looked like a mismatch: Paul has won four straight and is second in points (619.86), while Derek has lost three straight. Derek's Thursday lead changes that. **Lij vs Andrew** is a rubber match at 1-1; Andrew, after six straight losses, needs it to avoid falling to 2-10.

Jake vs Juan is a meeting of the bottom two, full rosters on both sides, with one win between them in twenty results. Jake claimed **Tank Dell**, and Juan added **Brian Thomas** and **Tyjae Spears**. Juan is 3-0 all-time against Jake. If Jake loses both results, he falls to **0-12**, the worst start in league history.

Scores, standings, Flex Rankings, records and the updated 2026 bylaws (with the 2027 draft pick chart) at Flex-appeal-FFL.grok.me, updated every Tuesday. Follow @FlexAppealFFL on X for live updates. Data: Sleeper API, through NFL Week 5 and Week 6 Thursday night.